

Shaping the body

Together, the skeletal system, the muscular system, and the skin support, shape, move, and cover the body. The bones of the skeletal system form a structure that is strong enough to support the body's weight, but light and flexible enough to allow it to move. The muscular system works with the skeleton to shape the body, and, by pulling bones, makes the body move. Skin provides a protective overcoat around the whole structure.



SMALLEST BONES

The three ossicles are the body's smallest bones. The tiniest ossicle is the size of a grain of rice. They are linked together and found in the ear, where they transmit sounds.